

SILAS M. FALDE

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SUMMARY

Highly motivated and detail-oriented Data Science junior and researcher at the University of Michigan, with a strong foundation in the programming languages C++ and Python. Proficient in data analysis and software development, with a passion for applying technical skills to a wide variety of problems. Currently seeking opportunities to leverage my skills and knowledge to contribute to innovative projects and teams.

EDUCATION

University of Michigan School of Engineering

Junior B.E.S. in Data Science, GPA: 3.13/4.00

Ann Arbor, MI

August 2023 – December 2026

Relevant Courses: Machine Learning, Artificial Intelligence, Database Management, Regression Analysis, Probability and Statistics, Data Structures and Algorithms

- Michigan Data Science Team (MDST) – Member 2 years
- Michigan Drone Technology (MDT) – Member 1 year

Western High School

GPA: 3.963

Parma, MI

August 2019 – May 2023

- Men's Varsity Soccer – Captain 1 year, Member 2 years
- Select Choir – Member 3 years

WORK EXPERIENCE

Ally Financial

Intern, Data Management

Detroit, MI

May 2025 – Present

- Creating data dictionaries and data lineage documentation leveraging Python, enhancing data governance and compliance.
- Adding data quality checks to existing data pipelines using Python and SQL, improving data integrity and reliability.
- Developing a data availability dashboard in Power BI to monitor data refresh rates and availability, ensuring timely access to critical data.

Michigan Soccer Referee Association

Certified Grassroots Soccer Referee

Ann Arbor, MI

March 2022 – Present

- Officiating on a referee team to create a safe, fair, and fun environment for players, coaches, and spectators.
- Applying knowledge of the rules of soccer to facilitate the sport.

Center Lake Fitness

Groundskeeper

Jackson, MI

May 2023 – August 2023

- Mowed, trimmed, and landscaped the grounds to maintain a clean and safe environment for patrons.
- Conducted daily care for farm animals including feeding, cleaning, monitoring animal health, and maintaining facilities.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

University of Michigan

Research Assistant

Ann Arbor, MI

September 2024 – Present

- Awarded 3rd place (top ~1%) in the CDC Youth Mental Health: Novel Variables Data Challenge.
- Developed **Python** pipelines using a large language model (LLM) on a high performance computing cluster to extract trends from the narratives of victims of suicide.

- Cleaned, preprocessed, and **feature engineered** a confidential dataset of over 400,000 narratives.
- Applied **natural language processing** techniques to identify relevant cases and enhance the annotation process.
- Documented findings with reports and visualizations both to communicate findings to the research team and the academic community through publication.

PROJECTS

Predicting Survival in the ICU

Ann Arbor, MI

Project Developer

January 2025 – March 2025

- Developed logistic regression and RNN models to predict survival of patients in the ICU using a public dataset using **Scikit-learn** and **PyTorch**.
- Performed data cleaning, preprocessing, and feature engineering to prepare the data for model training.
- Fine-tuned and evaluated the models using **cross-validation** and **grid search**.

SKILLS

Programming	C++, Python, R
Python	PyTorch, Scikit-learn, NumPy, Pandas, Matplotlib
Software	Git, VS Code, Microsoft Office Suite, Google Suite, Snowflake, Collibra, Alation, Manta